



2026 Elementary Spell Bowl List



1. a cappella	51. antonym	101. bruise	151. conceal
2. abdominal	52. aorta	102. buffaloes	152. conceit
3. ability	53. apologetic	103. bureaucracy	153. concentrate
4. aborigines	54. apostrophe	104. burlap	154. concrete
5. abrasion	55. apparent	105. business	155. condensation
6. acceptance	56. appendicitis	106. caffeine	156. conduction
7. accidentally	57. appliance	107. calendar	157. confinement
8. accommodations	58. apricot	108. calves	158. congratulatory
9. accomplished	59. Arabic	109. campaign	159. congressional
10. achievement	60. arc	110. Canberra	160. conjugation
11. acquire	61. architect	111. candle	161. Connecticut
12. acronym	62. arctic circle	112. canister	162. conquest
13. acupuncture	63. arrive	113. canvas	163. conscious
14. Addis Ababa	64. associate	114. canyon	164. consent
15. adequate	65. asterisk	115. capsule	165. conservation
16. adhesive	66. astronomical	116. cardiology	166. constellation
17. adjourn	67. atoll	117. carriage	167. construction
18. admissible	68. athlete	118. category	168. continent
19. Adriatic Sea	69. auditor	119. cauliflower	169. contour
20. aerobic	70. aurora borealis	120. celery	170. controversial
21. affectionately	71. autobiography	121. cell wall	171. convertible
22. Afghanistan	72. autumn	122. Celsius	172. cooperative
23. against	73. average	123. cent	173. coral
24. aghast	74. badger	124. certainly	174. correspondent
25. agriculture	75. balconies	125. channeled	175. cough
26. air fryer	76. banquet	126. chaperone	176. counsel
27. aisle	77. barbecue	127. Chattanooga	177. courtroom
28. Alberta	78. bargain	128. cheetah	178. creativity
29. algebra	79. Baton Rouge	129. Chesapeake Bay	179. critical
30. alignment	80. battery	130. chow mein	180. crochet
31. all clear	81. beach	131. Cinderella	181. cross-country
32. Allegheny	82. beginning	132. circumference	182. cuckoo
33. almanac	83. beige	133. citizen	183. cultivate
34. aloe	84. Beijing	134. clamored	184. cupboard
35. altar	85. believe	135. clemency	185. currency
36. altitude	86. benefiting	136. clique	186. cursive
37. amazingly	87. Bern	137. coagulation	187. customary
38. ambassador	88. bicentennial	138. cocoon	188. cylinder
39. ambulance	89. biome	139. collaboration	189. dad joke
40. amicable	90. biosphere	140. colleague	190. daughter
41. amoeba	91. Bismarck	141. colloquial	191. debris
42. analyze	92. board	142. colonist	192. December
43. ancient	93. bologna	143. colossal	193. declaration
44. angel	94. boomerang	144. comfortable	194. defensive
45. anthropologist	95. botanical	145. commercial	195. delicacy
46. anticipated	96. bough	146. companion	196. deliveries
47. antidote	97. brachiosaur	147. competitor	197. deluxe
48. antigen	98. brake	148. complement	198. Des Moines
49. antiperspirant	99. breakfast	149. composting	199. desert
50. antiseptic	100. bridle	150. compromise	200. determination



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201. development	251. famous	301. guarantee	351. jellyfish
202. dialogue	252. fashion	302. Gulf of Mexico	352. jewelry
203. difference	253. fatigue	303. gyroscope	353. jubilant
204. dilapidated	254. favorable	304. happiness	354. judgeship
205. diplomat	255. feasible	305. hazelnut	355. judiciary
206. disappoint	256. ferocious	306. Heidelberg	356. julienne
207. disastrous	257. field	307. heptagon	357. jurisprudence
208. discount	258. filament	308. heredity	358. juvenile
209. discuss	259. finally	309. hesitation	359. Kabul
210. disease	260. fjord	310. hieroglyphic	360. Kentucky
211. dismal	261. flagrant	311. histamine	361. kingdom
212. dissatisfied	262. flashback	312. hoarse	362. knapsack
213. District of Columbia	263. flexible	313. holiday	363. knight
214. dolphin	264. Florida	314. homesickness	364. knotted
215. dozen	265. fluctuation	315. homonym	365. knuckle
216. drought	266. Fluffernutter	316. horizontally	366. lacquer
217. dungeon	267. flutter	317. hospital	367. laissez-faire
218. economic	268. foothill	318. humidifier	368. larvae
219. educator	269. forest	319. humorously	369. lasagna
220. Egyptian	270. forgettable	320. hurricane	370. laundromat
221. either	271. fortress	321. Idaho	371. leisurely
222. elector	272. fourteen	322. idol	372. leprechaun
223. elegant	273. fragile	323. illegible	373. liaison
224. eligible	274. fraudulent	324. illumination	374. license
225. elusive	275. frequently	325. imaginary	375. ligament
226. embroidery	276. frontier	326. immediate	376. liquefy
227. emphatic	277. functional	327. immigrant	377. lithium
228. enclosure	278. furious	328. immunization	378. livable
229. encyclopedia	279. Galileo	329. impersonator	379. llama
230. engineering	280. gasket	330. impressionable	380. loam
231. enough	281. gauge	331. impulsive	381. loaves
232. enthusiasm	282. gecko	332. incessant	382. locavore
233. epidermal	283. generation	333. inconsiderate	383. lodge
234. equivocal	284. genius	334. Indiana	384. Louisiana
235. escape room	285. Georgia	335. individuality	385. lovable
236. estimated	286. gesture	336. ineligible	386. ludicrous
237. estuary	287. glossaries	337. inflammation	387. lunar eclipse
238. eventful	288. gnome	338. initiative	388. Luxembourg
239. exasperated	289. Golden Gate	339. innocently	389. luxurious
240. excel	290. good-natured	340. insistent	390. lyrical
241. exceptionally	291. government	341. inspirational	391. Mackinaw
242. executive	292. grammatical	342. intercept	392. mahogany
243. exhilarated	293. Grand Rapids	343. interrogation	393. maize
244. exoskeleton	294. graphite	344. intersect	394. Malaysia
245. experience	295. Great Britain	345. invitation	395. mammoth
246. extenuating	296. greenhouse effect	346. irrelevant	396. manicure
247. extinguish	297. gregarious	347. irresistible	397. manipulate
248. extreme	298. grievance	348. isthmus	398. marbling
249. facilities	299. grocery	349. January	399. marshmallow
250. fallacy	300. growth	350. jaywalker	400. Maryland



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401. mastiff	451. nourishment	501. physicist	551. receipt
402. measurable	452. nuisance	502. pickleball	552. recession
403. medication	453. numerous	503. pier	553. recipient
404. medulla	454. nurse-practitioner	504. pilot	554. reconciliation
405. megaphone	455. nuzzle	505. pinprick	555. recuperate
406. membrane	456. o'clock	506. Pittsburgh	556. reef
407. Memorial Day	457. obedience	507. plankton	557. reflex
408. Mesopotamia	458. objection	508. platitude	558. refuge
409. metamorphosis	459. obtain	509. plead	559. relaxation
410. meteorite	460. occasion	510. pliant	560. reliable
411. metropolitan	461. October	511. poisonous	561. remainder
412. Michigan City	462. Okeechobee Lake	512. polka dot	562. renowned
413. Milky Way	463. omission	513. Polynesian	563. repetition
414. mimic	464. Oobleck	514. porcupine	564. reprieve
415. minestrone	465. operation	515. possession	565. rescuing
416. minute	466. opponent	516. postgraduate	566. resident
417. mischief	467. optimistic	517. potatoes	567. responsible
418. Mississippi	468. orchestra	518. practical	568. resumed
419. misspell	469. orient	519. prairie dog	569. reverberate
420. molt	470. orthodontist	520. precarious	570. rhapsody
421. monologue	471. Ottawa	521. precipice	571. rhetoric
422. Monroe Doctrine	472. overdue	522. predestination	572. Rhode Island
423. Montana	473. pageant	523. prediction	573. rhythm
424. moonwalk	474. paleontology	524. preliminary	574. right
425. Morse code	475. pamphlet	525. preoccupied	575. roadrunner
426. mosque	476. pandemonium	526. present	576. rodeo
427. Mount Rainier	477. panorama	527. pretzel	577. rotation
428. Mozambique	478. parachute	528. prime number	578. rustle
429. murmur	479. paradox	529. principal	579. ruthless
430. mustache	480. parallelogram	530. principle	580. sabotage
431. myriad	481. Parthenon	531. probability	581. safflower oil
432. narrative	482. passenger	532. proceed	582. sailor
433. national	483. pastime	533. proclamation	583. salami
434. naturalist	484. patent	534. progressive	584. salutation
435. nautical	485. patriotic	535. prompt	585. sanction
436. Near East	486. peace	536. proposed	586. sandal
437. necessary	487. pedigree	537. provinces	587. sandstorm
438. negotiable	488. peninsula	538. pseudopod	588. satire
439. nervous	489. pentagram	539. public	589. saucer
440. neutralization	490. percent	540. putrefy	590. savannah
441. New Hampshire	491. perfume	541. quadrilateral	591. scampi
442. Newfoundland	492. periscope	542. quarterfinal	592. scapula
443. Nicaragua	493. personification	543. Quebec	593. scavenger
444. nightmare	494. Peshawar	544. questionnaire	594. scene
445. ninety	495. pessimism	545. quicksand	595. scheduling
446. nobody	496. petition	546. quitting	596. scholarship
447. nomad	497. pharmacist	547. quizzes	597. screwdriver
448. nondescript	498. phenomenon	548. raccoon	598. sculptor
449. nonrenewable	499. photographer	549. random	599. Second Gentleman
450. North Carolina	500. photosynthesis	550. realize	600. secondary



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601. secretary	651. symmetry	701. valuable
602. seize	652. synagogue	702. vaporize
603. self-employed	653. tablespoon	703. vegetation
604. senator	654. Taipei	704. velodrome
605. sensitive	655. tamale	705. venomous
606. sentimental	656. tambourine	706. ventriloquist
607. sequel	657. tardiness	707. Vermont
608. severely	658. teammate	708. vertebrae
609. Shetland	659. tenant	709. vice president
610. shipwreck	660. tentative	710. Victorian
611. shoulder	661. terrarium	711. vigilance
612. Sierra Nevada	662. thermos	712. Vincennes
613. signature	663. thickening	713. Virginia
614. silence	664. thorax	714. virus
615. similar	665. threw	715. vision
616. simplified	666. through	716. visualize
617. sinusitis	667. thunderstorm	717. vortex
618. siphon	668. tier	718. wallflower
619. slippery	669. tiresome	719. warehouse
620. snagged	670. toboggan	720. Warsaw
621. sociable	671. tomorrow	721. watershed
622. sombrero	672. topsy-turvy	722. wavelength
623. sophomore	673. tornadoes	723. weather
624. soufflé	674. totem pole	724. weigh-in
625. South Carolina	675. tradition	725. well-intentioned
626. sovereignty	676. transferred	726. westernization
627. spaghetti	677. transmittable	727. wheezy
628. specimen	678. tremor	728. whether
629. speech	679. triangular	729. whinny
630. spelunking	680. trilogy	730. wholesaler
631. spoiler	681. Tropic of Capricorn	731. whose
632. sportsmanship	682. tundra	732. windshield
633. stadium	683. turbine	733. windsurfing
634. statistician	684. Tuscaloosa	734. woodwind
635. stomachache	685. twelfth	735. worshipping
636. strait	686. two-dimensional	736. wouldn't
637. stratus	687. tyranny	737. wreckage
638. strenuous	688. ultimatum	738. written
639. submit	689. umbilical cord	739. xylem
640. substitution	690. unbiased	740. Yellowstone
641. succeed	691. uncomfortable	741. Yokohama
642. suede	692. unison	742. Yosemite Valley
643. sunlight	693. unpleasant	743. yule
644. superintendent	694. until	744. zander
645. surgeon	695. uproariously	745. zephyr
646. surveillance	696. urgent	746. zeppelin
647. suspend	697. vacancies	747. Zimbabwe
648. sweatshirt	698. vaccine	748. zoodles
649. swimming	699. vacuum cleaner	749. zoological
650. sycamore	700. vain	750. zooplankton

This word list is the fifth of a series of five yearly lists that are released in mid-May.

The only sources used for pronunciations and definitions used in the competitions will be the Merriam-Webster's *Collegiate Dictionary*, Eleventh Edition, and <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary>. Words must have identical spellings in both this word list and the dictionary to be used in competition. If a discrepancy appears, words that do not match will not be used in competition. Every effort was made to select only words that are appropriate for school use. If necessary, a list of words that have been eliminated from the list will be posted at <https://iasp.org/student-programs/spell-bowl/>